



BRAND SYSTEM / 02

History, pinned to place.

A practical identity system for a place-connected Black history platform.

One idea. Four promises.

The identity should feel authoritative without becoming institutional and modern without becoming disposable.

BRAND IDEA

The book is the record.
The pin is the place.
The B is the name.

Black Book helps people see what happened, where it happened, why it mattered, and how the record supports it.

Specific

Name the person, place, institution, event, evidence, and uncertainty.

Alive

Connect history to the streets, schools, institutions, and communities people know today.

Evidence-led

Show sources, confidence, disputes, and review status as part of the experience.

Respectful

Center dignity and relevance. Avoid spectacle, flattening, and anonymous representation.

The mark is the first B.

The official lockup is artwork. Do not recreate it by typing the full name beside the symbol.

PRIMARY / LIGHT SURFACES



USE

Navigation, landing pages, presentations, credits, and major brand moments on Archive Paper or Surface.

REVERSED / DARK SURFACES



USE

Dark navigation, cinematic story pages, social graphics, and app launch surfaces.

CORE RULE

Visible text begins with "lack Book." The symbol already supplies the first B.

Every shape carries meaning.

The symbol should read as a B first, then reveal the book, pages, and place marker.



01

Book cover

The durable record and the visual spine of the mark.

02

Page bands

Layered sources, perspectives, revisions, and stories.

03

Place pin

Geographic context, local discovery, and the active-location signal.

04

Custom B silhouette

The product name becomes a memorable product idea rather than a detached icon.

RECOGNITION ORDER

B → book → place. At small sizes, preserve the B and pin before preserving every page band.

Use the smallest expression that stays unmistakable.

The family is intentionally limited. Fewer variants create stronger recognition.

Primary mark

Avatar, map chrome, watermark



Monochrome

Single-color print and constrained production



Primary lockup

Default signature for headers and major moments



Preferred whenever the product name must be understood immediately.

Compact mark

Small UI, favicon, dense controls



Application icons

Light and dark OS contexts



Protect the silhouette.

The page bands and pin need room to survive responsive layouts, browser chrome, and small icons.

X



MINIMUM SIZES

X equals the visible width of the copper pin. Keep at least one X on every side.

 **Primary lockup**
168 px digital / 36 mm print

 **Primary mark**
32 px minimum

 **Compact mark**
20 px minimum

Never squeeze the clear space to fit navigation. Reduce adjacent UI or switch to the compact mark.

Black and paper lead. Copper points.

Copper is a navigational signal, not a decorative wash or default text color.

Black Ink

#0A0A0A

Archive Paper

#F4EFE5

Copper Pin

#B86B2A

Page Sand

#D8A178

Stone

#6D675F

Surface

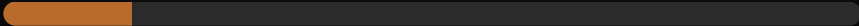
#FBF8F2

ACCESSIBLE TEXT PAIRS

FOREGROUND	BACKGROUND	RATIO	USE
Black Ink	Archive Paper	17.3:1	Primary text
#8E4F2A	Archive Paper	5.5:1	Copper text on light
#D07A32	Black Ink	6.1:1	Copper text on dark
Stone	Archive Paper	4.9:1	Secondary text

ACCENT DISCIPLINE

Use copper for the moment of orientation.



Aim for roughly 10–15% of a composition. Use it for active locations, selected filters, actions, and evidence markers.

One contemporary voice with editorial depth.

The logo wordmark remains outlined artwork. Site typography supports it; it does not reconstruct it.

DISPLAY + UI

History lives here.

Inter Display + Inter

Headlines, navigation, controls, summaries, and product language. Use 600–700 for display and 400–600 for UI.

EDITORIAL

A record is
strongest when its
context remains
visible.

Source Serif 4

Long-form stories, essays, quotations, and archival interpretation. Use 400–600.

DATA + CITATIONS

SOURCE 04
CONF 0.91

IBM Plex Mono

Metadata, citations, dates, confidence, review status, and technical labels. Use 400–500.

RESPONSIVE TYPE SCALE

Use fluid sizing between mobile and desktop, with tighter tracking only at display sizes.

DISPLAY

48–72

H1

36–48

H2

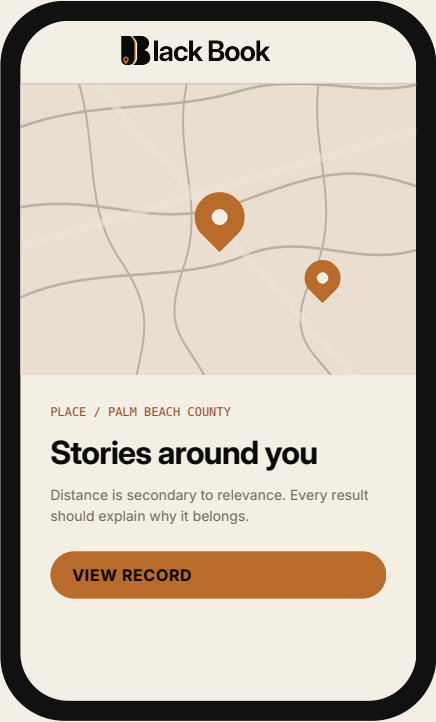
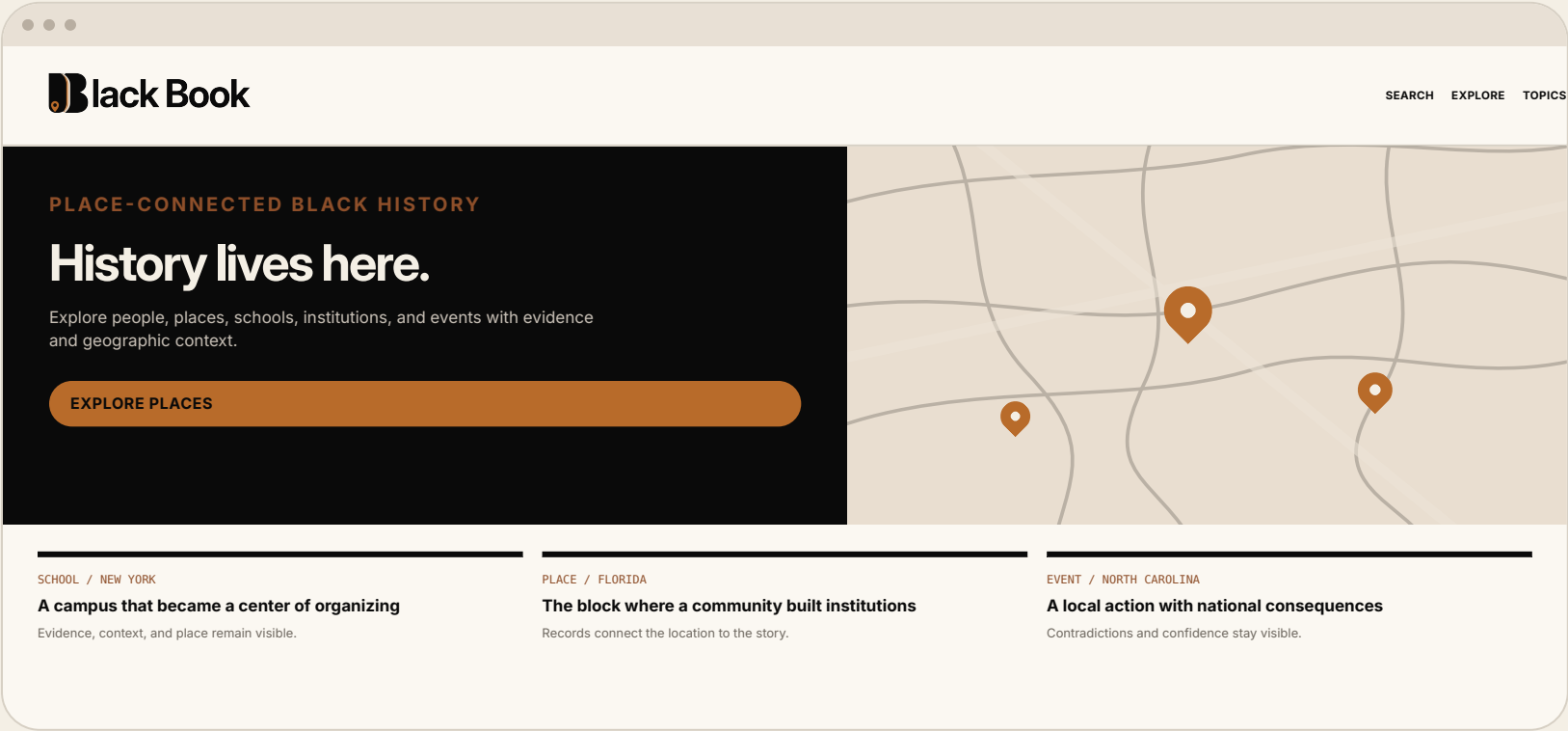
24–32

BODY

16–18

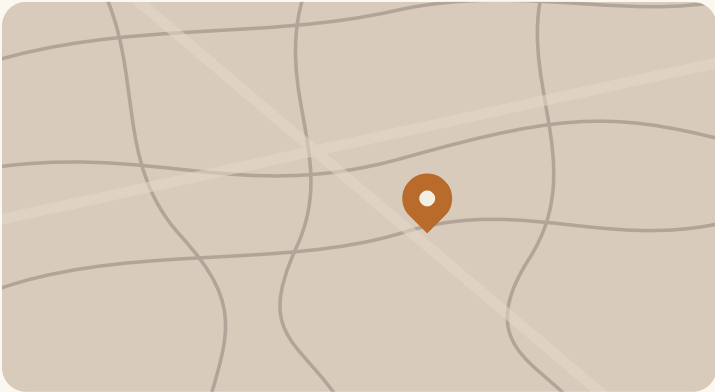
The brand should feel native to the product.

The signature, map language, story rails, typography, and evidence metadata work as one system.



Show place, evidence, and people with dignity.

The image should add context, not substitute for sourcing or turn history into mood-board decoration.



Place first

Establish streets, neighborhoods, schools, institutions, landscapes, or geographic relationships.

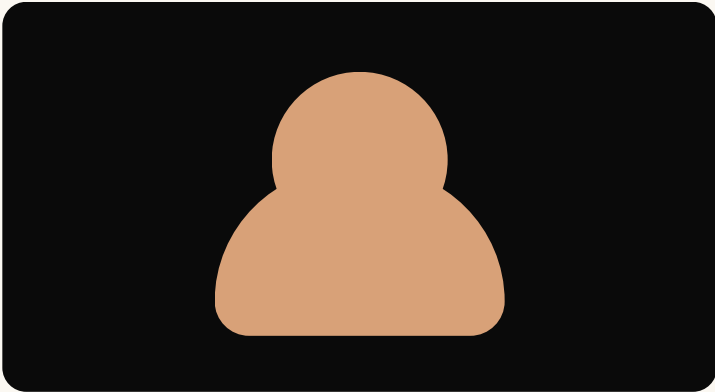
LOCATION / DATE / SOURCE



Evidence visible

Show documents, artifacts, maps, captions, and provenance as part of the story.

COLLECTION / RIGHTS / CITATION



People with context

Identify who, where, when, and why. Avoid anonymous representation or generic symbolism.

PERSON / ROLE / PLACE / YEAR

AVOID

Generic “Black history” stock imagery, automatic sepia filters, AI images presented as documentary material, sensational imagery, anonymous portraits, or maps without source and precision context.

Precise enough to trust. Human enough to explore.

The voice should invite curiosity without flattening complexity or lecturing the audience.



Specific over sweeping

Name the person, place, institution, event, source, and uncertainty.



Evidence before assertion

Distinguish documented fact, interpretation, dispute, and unknown.



Pride without spectacle

Honor agency and achievement without turning every story into triumph or trauma.



Invite, do not lecture

Use clear language, explain why a record matters, and make the evidence easy to inspect.

PREFER

“See what happened here.”

Direct, local, and curious.

“Every record should show why it belongs.”

Transparent about relevance.

AVOID

“The untold truth they hid from you.”

Sensational and unsupported.

“Everything you need to know.”

Overclaims completeness.

CORE LINE

History, pinned to place.

SUPPORT LINE

People. Places. Evidence. Context.

Consistency protects recognition.

These examples show actual failure modes, not only written rules.



Do not type a second B
The symbol already replaces the first letter.



Do not stretch
Keep the approved proportions and spacing.



Do not recolor randomly
Use only approved light, dark, and monochrome assets.



Do not add effects
No rotation, bevel, glow, texture, or ornamental motion.



Do not remove the pin
The pin is part of the primary symbol's meaning.



Do not overcrowd
Preserve clear space around every lockup.

Ship the system, not a screenshot.

Use transparent vector or PNG assets, semantic theme tokens, and the compact mark at genuinely small sizes.

ASSET SELECTION

PLACEMENT	PREFERRED ASSET	NOTES
Website header	black-book-primary-light.svg black-book-primary-dark.svg	Use the theme-appropriate outlined SVG.
App launcher	black-book-app-icon-*-1024.png	Use the platform-ready square icon.
Favicon	favicon-*-16/32/48.png	Use the compact mark, not the full lockup.
Social avatar	social-avatar-*-512.png	Keep safe area intact; do not crop the B.
Print	primary-monochrome-*.svg	Use only when color is unavailable.
Presentation	primary-*-transparent.png	Transparent PNG is safest in office tools.

THEME TOKENS

```
--bb-ink: #0A0A0A;  
--bb-paper: #F4EFE5;  
--bb-copper: #B86B2A;  
--bb-copper-text-light: #8E4F2A;  
--bb-copper-text-dark: #D07A32;  
--bb-font-display: "Inter Display", Inter, sans-serif;  
--bb-font-editorial: "Source Serif 4", Georgia, serif;
```

LAUNCH CHECKLIST

- ✓

Correct light/dark asset
- ✓

Transparent background verified
- ✓

Alt text names the product
- ✓

Compact mark below 32 px
- ✓

No typed second B
- ✓

Clear space preserved
- ✓

Copper not used for body text
- ✓

Source and rights labels visible



**History, pinned to
place.**

Black Book brand system v2.0 · Logo masters, transparent exports, icons, tokens, and implementation guidance.